DMC notes on The Matrix

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Notes in Preface

Lens: Analysis of Societal Control (Deleuze - Societies of Control)

In class three, we will focus on the 1999 movie *The Matrix*. The mind control here is total control of reality itself. Our hero, Neo, chooses to swallow the "red pill," which lets him see that the entire world he has been living in is an elaborate computer simulation.

The previous dystopian elements of controlling outliers via a kind of police state, and controlling the narrative through controlling language are relevant to this story. In addition, the movie is prophetic of the encroachment of virtual reality on our present-day world.

A tool here is to examine how society is being controlled[1].

We will ask questions such as:

- *Who or what is controlling society?*
- *How is it being controlled?*

[1] On societies of control, see

- Postscript on the Societies of Control, Gilles Deleuze, L'Autre journal, no. 1, May 1990.
- Disciplinary societies and Societies of control, CourseCompendium.

> "The disciplinary societies, as defined by Foucault, are in the process of becoming societies of control, as defined by Deleuze, Chantal Mouffe (2012: 23) contends. This transition, which does not necessarily imply a complete replacement or displacement, is marked by the emergence of a new paradigm of power. In the disciplinary societies, command is exercised through the articulation of a network of apparatuses (dispositifs) that produce, and regulate customs, habits and practices of production, the major disciplinary institutions being the family, school, factories, asylums and hospitals. In societies of control, however, command is immanent to the social field, distributed to the minds and bodies of the citizens."